



Worn for a Week, Read for a Year

Surveying How Long an Orientation-Week Lanyard's Colour Follows a Student

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Background

Orientation week colour-codes commencing students' lanyards by admission pathway to route tour groups, a scheme meant to end with orientation. Does the colour still mean anything to the people a student meets months later?

Aims

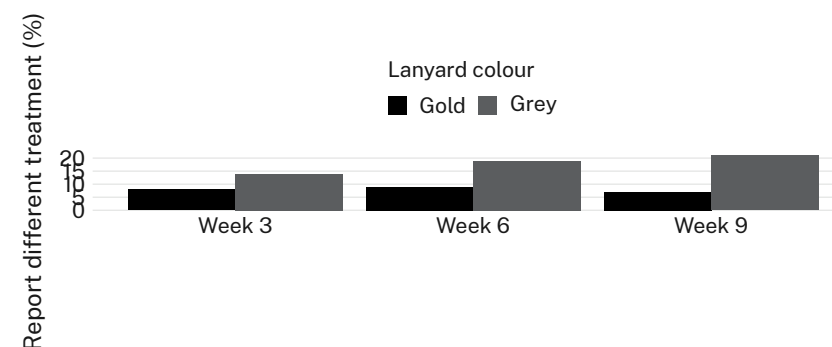
- Measure lanyard-colour recall among commencing students at week nine
- Test whether recall tracks perceived differential treatment by tutors or peers
- Assess whether the sorting scheme needs a formal retirement point

Methods

- 612 students surveyed at week nine · recall + a 5-item treatment scale
- scores compared across lanyard colours (gold = ATAR entry, grey = alternative entry) via ordinal regression
- survey order randomised; tutors not informed of the survey's subject

Results

More than half of respondents could still name their lanyard colour at week nine; grey-lanyard students reported a small, consistent treatment gap that gold-lanyard students did not.



Reported different treatment, by lanyard colour: the grey/gold gap widens from 6 points at week 3 to 14 points at week 9 (n = 612).

Discussion & conclusions

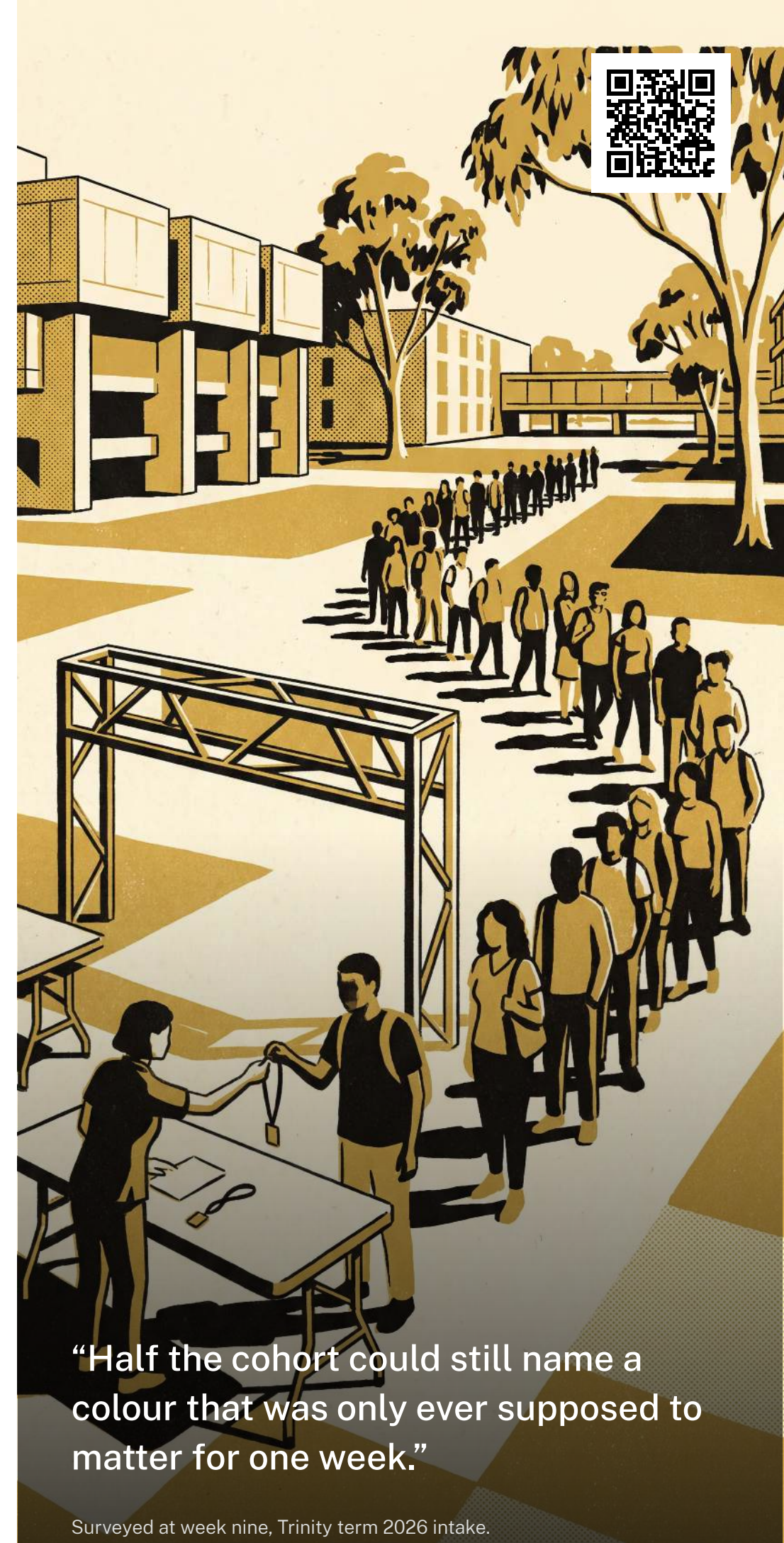
A wayfinding tool with no designed persistence is still legible, nine weeks on, to the people wearing it. Sorting by admission pathway wasn't retired; it just stopped being logged. Next: test whether a single unbadged stream removes the gap, or just moves it somewhere less visible.

References

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Lanyard colour was assigned before consent for the survey was sought; no participant's individual colour or pathway is reported below cohort level.

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“Half the cohort could still name a colour that was only ever supposed to matter for one week.”

Surveyed at week nine, Trinity term 2026 intake.